vaguely crescent-shaped object. He has been denounced by the Anti-Defamation League for peddling “anti-Muslim bigotry.”

Gaffney’s views have a following in Trump Tower. Bannon hosted Gaffney on his radio show dozens of times, and there were reports that he was brought in to advise the transition (though Trump’s team denied it). And Dermer praised him warmly, calling him a steadfast friend of Israel. “If you have enemies, Frank, it’s because you have stood up for something, many times in your life,” he said, echoing Churchill.

These sorts of comments gamble with Israel’s decades of unquestioned diplomatic and military support from Washington. Israel often claims that “shared values” unite it with America; its top representative in Washington thoroughly undercuts that argument by embracing far-right racists. “American Jews having that automatic connection and attachment to Israel can no longer be an operating assumption,” said Fox. “The generation that lived through the miracle of 1948, the generation that saw the 1967 war, there was no question about loyalty. But today we can no longer assume that connection is there.”

The tension between liberalism and Zionism, always lingering below the surface, has become more pronounced. And the Israeli government’s embrace of a president (and his controversial political coterie) loathed by the vast majority of American Jews will only widen the chasm. “He thinks that he knows the United States better than anybody else in this country,” said Efraim Halevy, a former Mossad director who became a fierce Netanyahu critic. “What he doesn’t know is that he knew a United States that no longer exists today.”